

NATALIA SERNA

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Last updated: October 7, 2026

Current appointment

Stanford University

Assistant Professor of Health Policy

09/2023 - 08/2027

Education

University of Wisconsin - Madison

PhD in Economics

05/2023

MS in Economics

06/2019

Icesi University

MS in Economics

06/2015

Bachelor in Economics and International Business

02/2014

Past appointments

University of Wisconsin - Madison

Research Assistant

Principal Investigator: Lorenzo Magnolfi.

07/2021 - 06/2022

University of Wisconsin - Madison

Research Assistant

Principal Investigator: Marguerite Burns.

01/2019 - 06/2020

Research fields

Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

Original peer-reviewed publications

Total publications: 12 Authors are organized in alphabetical order based on last names, unless otherwise stated.

1. Buitrago, G., Rodriguez-Lesmes, P., **Serna, N.**, and Vera-Hernandez, M. Do Health Insurers Matter for Health Outcomes? Evidence from a Large Natural Experiment in Colombia? **Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics.**
2. **Serna, N.** (2026). Determinants of Provider Networks: Risk Selection vs. Administrative Costs. **Forthcoming, American Economic Journal: Microeconomics.**

3. **Serna. N.** (2025). Exogenous Exits, Market Structure, and Equilibrium Contracts in Healthcare. **American Economic Review: Insights**, 7(3), 325-339.
4. Magnolfi, L., Mommaerts, C., **Serna. N.**, and Sullivan, C. (2024) The Rise of Urgent Care Centers: Implications for Competition and Access to Health Care. **Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics**, 2(2), 201-243.
5. McNamara, C. and **Serna. N.**, (2022). The Impact of a National Formulary Expansion on Diabetics, **Health Economics**, 31(11), 2311-2332.
6. **Serna. N.**, (2021). Cost Sharing and the Demand for Health Services in a Regulated Market, (2021). **Health Economics**, 30(6), 1259-1275.
7. Burns, M., Dague, L., Saloner, B. **Serna. N.***, Voskuil, K., Kim, N., and Look, K., (2020). Implementing Parity for Mental Health and Substance Use Treatment in Medicaid. **Health Services Research**, 55(4).
**Statistical analysis. Administrative, technical, or material support.*
8. Saloner, B., Dague, L., Friedsam, D., **Serna. N.***, Volskuil, K., and Burns, M., (2019). Access to Care Among Individuals Who Experienced Medicaid Lockouts After Premium Nonpayment, **Journal of the American Medical Association, Network Open**, 2(11).
**Statistical analysis. Administrative, technical, or material support.*
9. Martin, J., Riascos, A., and **Serna. N.**, (2019). Welfare Effects of Switching Barriers Through Permanence Clauses: Evidence from the Mobiles Market in Colombia, **Telecommunications Research**, 43(4).
10. Riascos, A. and **Serna. N.**, (2018). Machine Learning Based Program to Prevent Hospitalizations and Reduce Costs in the Colombian Statutory Health Care System, (2018). **International Journal of Knowledge Discovery in Bioinformatics**, 8(2).
11. Riascos, A., Romero, M., and **Serna. N.**, (2018). Risk Adjustment Revisited using Machine Learning Techniques, **Proceeding Series of the Brazilian Society of Computational and Applied Mathematics**, 6(2).
12. Riascos, A. and **Serna. N.**, (2017). Predicting Annual Length-of-Stay and its Impact on Health Costs: The Case of the Colombian Healthcare System, **Proceedings of Machine Learning Research**, 69.

Working papers

How Much Health Insurer Market Power is Too Much? Theory and Evidence from Quality Competition. *Reject and Resubmit, Review of Economic Studies.*

Segmentation in Pharmaceutical Markets: Evidence from Contraceptives.— With Jorge Florez, Santiago Ortiz-Ortiz, Paul Rodríguez-Lesmes.

Performance Pay for Health Insurers: Evidence from Colombia's High-Cost Account—With Lin-Tung Tsai.

The Equilibrium Effects of Automatic Enrollment in Health Insurance—With Giancarlo Buitrago, Paul Rodríguez-Lesmes, Marcos Vera-Hernandez. *Under review*

The Costs of Violent Deaths. *Under review*

Price Levels, Non-Linear Contracts, and Medical Decisions—With Cici McNamara. *Under review*

Inequality in Life Expectancy Across Small Areas in the United States and Colombia—With Grant Miller, Paul Rodríguez-Lesmes, Iván Mejía, Eran Bendavid. *Under review*

Selected work in progress

Supply-side Drivers of Access to Long-Acting Reversible Contraceptives: Evidence from Medicaid Beneficiaries—
With Maya Rossin-Slater and Lin-Tung Tsai.

Does Managed Care Affect Breast Cancer Outcomes?—With Karla Hernandez.

Presentations

Invited Seminars - Total: 20

FTC Microeconomics Seminar (Washington D.C., 2026 – Scheduled), UCLA CCPR (Los Angeles, CA, 2026 – Scheduled), Berkeley School of Public Health (Berkeley, CA, 2026), International Development Bank (Washington D.C., 2025), Harvard University (Cambridge, MA, 2025), Georgetown University (Washington D.C., 2024), University College London (London, United Kingdom, 2024), Stanford Medicine Grand Rounds (Stanford, CA, 2023), University of Pennsylvania (Philadelphia, PA, 2023), London School of Economics and Political Science (London, United Kingdom, 2023), Boston University (Boston, MA, 2023), Ohio State University (Columbus, OH, 2023), California Institute of Technology (Pasadena, CA, 2023), Olin School of Business (St. Louis, MO, 2023), Ross School of Business (MI, 2023), Stanford Health Policy (Stanford, CA, 2023), Kelley School of Business (Bloomington, IN, 2023), University of Toronto (Virtual, 2023), Central Bank of Colombia (Bogota, Colombia, 2023), Quantil Colombia (Virtual, 2023).

Conferences - Total: 23

All California Labor Economics Conference (Berkeley, CA, 09/2026 – Scheduled), Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics–Health Inequality (Stanford, CA, 08/2026), Becker Friedman Institute–Reproduction in Society (Chicago, IL, 08/2026), IO Fest (Stanford, CA, 10/2025), Health Economics Conference (Toulouse, France, 06/2025), International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC) (Philadelphia, PA, 04/2025), California Health Economics Conference (Los Angeles, CA, 11/2024), American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) (San Diego, CA, 06/2024), Bates White Life Sciences Symposium (Washington D.C., 05/2024), International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC) (Boston, MA, 05/2024), Health Economics and Policy Innovation Collaborative (HEPIC) (Atlanta, GA, 04/2024), National Bureau of Economic Research, Spring Meeting (Cambridge, MA, NBER IO) (Stanford, CA, 02/2024), Junior Health Economics Summit (Whistler, Canada, 02/2024), Becker Friedman Institute, Women in Empirical Microeconomics (Chicago, IL, 09/2023), National Bureau of Economic Research, Summer Institute (NBER IO) (Boston, MA, 07/2023), International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC) (Washington D.C., 04/2023), Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) (Stanford, CA, 07/2022), American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) (Austin, TX, 06/2022), International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC) (Boston, MA, 04/2022), Midwest Economics Association (MEA) (Minneapolis, MN, 03/2022), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) (Austin, TX, 11/2021), Midwest Economics Association (MEA) (Virtual, 03/2021), American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) (Virtual, 06/2021)

Teaching Experience

Health Care Systems Around the World (Undergraduate)
Human Biology Program, Stanford University.

Winter 2025, 2026

R Software (MSc)
Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin - Madison.

Spring 2019

Elementary Matrix and Linear Algebra (Undergraduate)
Department of Mathematics, University of Wisconsin - Madison.

Fall 2018

Grants

Active

Research Grant, co-PI Arnold Ventures	01/2026 - 12/2027
Research Grant, PI King Center Global Development Research	06/2026 - 06/2028

Pending

K01 Career Development Award, PI National Institutes of Health	04/2027 - 03/2032
R21 Exploratory Research Grant, PI National Institutes of Health	04/2027 - 03/2029

Completed

Discovery Innovation Fund, PI Stanford University	02/2025 - 01/2026
Rosenkranz Prize, PI Stanford University	05/2024 - 05/2026
Caves Dissertation Fellowship Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin - Madison	05/2022 - 05/2023
Richard E. Stockwell Dissertation Fellowship Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin - Madison	05/2021 - 05/2022
Summer Fellowship Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin - Madison	05/2019 - 08/2019

Service

Peer-Review Service

American Economic Review, Review of Economics and Statistics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, The Economic Journal, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Human Resources, Health Economics Journal, B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy.

Service as Grant Reviewer

U.S. National Science Foundation

Service to Professional Organizations

Scientific committee for RIDGE Industrial Organization Workshop.